

Topic: Life in Makkah

Israa and Mairaj

Q (a) Write an account of the Prophet's (PBUH) Night Journey and Ascension [Isra Wa Mai'raj]. [10]

Structure of Answer		
Para 1 (The Night Journey)	Para 2 (Ascension)	Para 3 (Response)
- A brief starter. 27th Rajab, 11th Year of Prophethood. - Prophet's (PBUH) journey from Makkah to Jerusalem on Burraq. - Places where He stopped and what He saw. - Prophet (PBUH) led all prophets in prayer. 3 Cups.	- Ascension through 7 heavens accompanied by Gabriel. - Meeting with different Prophets. 7th Heaven, Ibrahim (AS), Bait-ul-Mamoor, Sidra-tul-Muntaha. - Heaven and Hell. - Meeting with Allah. - Prayers.	- Quraysh mockery and taunting. - Abu Bakr 'Al-Siddeeq' (RA) - Test (The Caravan) - Quraysh's arrogance.

Answer

- ☐ 10th year of Prophethood: Prophet (PBUH) lost Khadija (Biggest moral and financial supporter) and Abu Talib (Tribal Protector)(Year of grief).
- ☐ Interval of Revelation: Revelation stopped for some time.
- ☐ Unsuccessful attempt to preach Islam at Ta'if.
- ☐ To uplift His morale and console Him, Allah blessed Him with Isra and Mairaj in 11th Year of Prophethood, 27th Rajab.
 -  Ref: "Exalted is He who took His Servant by night from al-Masjid al-Haram to al-Masjid al-Aqsa..." [17:1]
- ☐ Prophet (PBUH) was woken up by Jibrail (AS) at Umm-e-Hani's (RA) place and taken to Hateem, the same incident that happened with him in his childhood happened again. His chest was split and heart was taken out and fixed back after being washed by Zamzam.
- ☐ An animal called Buraq was brought that was larger than donkey and smaller than horse. It is written in Bukhari about its speed:
 -  "The animal's step reached the farthest point within the reach of the animal's sight."
- ☐ Gabriel guided Prophet (PBUH) to stop and offer prayer at 4 points:
 - 📍 Yathrib (Madinah) Gabriel mentioned that you will migrate to this place.
 - 📍 Sina (Where Allah talked to Musa AS)
 - 📍 Madyan (where Hazrat Shoaib AS was designated)
 - 📍 Bet-ul-Lahm (Birthplace of Jesus AS)
- ☐ Prophet (PBUH) saw some people in luxury, upon asking He was told by Gabriel that they are the ones who strive hard in the way of Allah.
- ☐ Then he saw some people in miserable condition, He was told that they are backbiters, Beneficiaries of Interest, Characterless people and other sinners.
- ☐ He reached Jerusalem and led all Prophets in prayer. This confirmed his leadership and superiority over all Prophets.
- ☐ Gabriel brought 3 cups full of Milk, Water and Vine. Prophet (PBUH) had to choose one, He chose milk. Upon asking He was told that if you had chosen vine, your nation would go astray. If you had chosen water your nation would be destroyed by disasters. Your choice milk is symbol of success and purity.



☐ This part of journey is called Isra (The Night Journey)
☐ Now this part of journey that starts from this point is called Mai'raj (Ascension) ☐ He used a Ladder or the Same Buraq for ascension. He was welcomed at all heavens by guardian angels. Met with Adam (RA) on the lowest heaven, Yahya and Jesus (AS) on 2 nd heaven, Yusuf (AS) on 3 rd , Idrees (RA) on 4 th , Haroon (AS) on 5 th , Musa (AS) on 6 th and Ibrahim (AS) on the 7 th one. ☐ He visited Bait-ul-Mamoor, Kaabah of Angels which is encompassed by 70 thousand angels on daily basis. Then He reached Sidra-tul-Muntaha (The Lote Tree). This place marks the ending point of seventh heaven and no creation can pass this point. ☐ Ref: "At the Lote Tree of the Utmost Boundary" [53:14] ☐ Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) was given a chance to have a glimpse of Paradise and Hell and Then to meet Allah (SWT) ☐ Ref: "Then he approached and descended, and was at a distance of two bow lengths or nearer. And he revealed to His Servant what he revealed." [53:8-10] ☐ He was given prayers as gift of Allah. ☐ He then descended back to Makkah. When he entered his room his bed was still warm and the hasp was still moving.
☐ Quraish response was as expected. They laughed and mocked Prophet Muhammad (PBUH). ☐ Quraysh tried to manipulate Abu Bakr (RA) by approaching him before Prophet (PBUH) and playing with his mind. But he disappointed them by believing in Prophet (PBUH) without any research or giving it a single thought. Therefore, He was given the title of "Al-Siddeeq" (The Testifier of Truth) ☐ Prophet (PBUH) told them about their trade caravan that was stuck in between coming back from Syria and prophet predicted its arrival date. And the caravan entered Makkah the same day Prophet (PBUH) predicted. When Quraysh asked the caravan about if they lost anything in the way, they accepted it. ☐ Quraysh were spellbound but still they did not believe in Holy Prophet (PBUH) and called it magic.

Q (b) Explain the importance of this journey to the Prophet (PBUH) himself. [04]

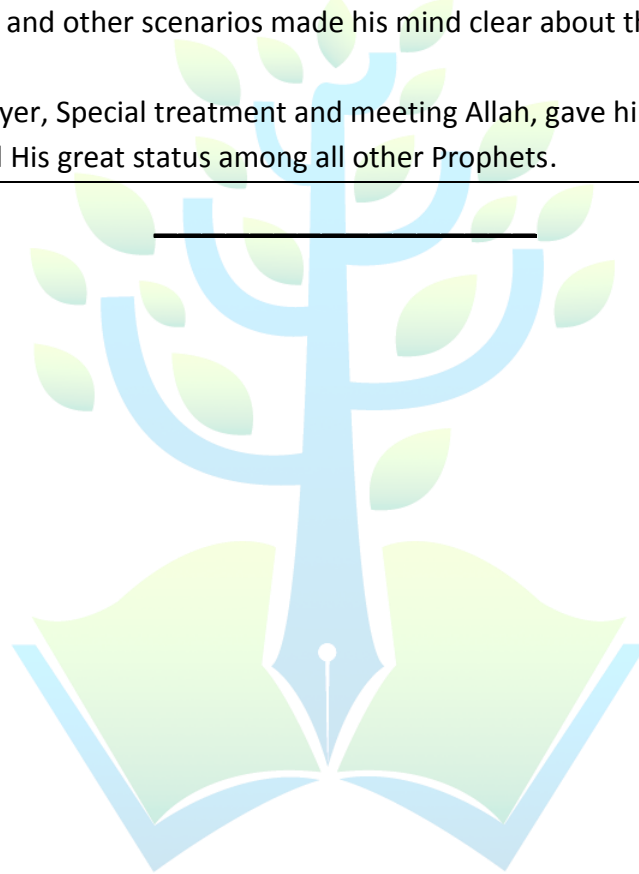
Points to be covered

☐ It was year of grief; Prophet (PBUH) had lost Khadija (RA) and Abu Talib who were his biggest supporters. Allah assured His support and consoled Prophet (PBUH) through Isra and Mairaj. ☐ After spending 10 years there was no tangible outcome from Quraysh. Quraysh mocked him that Allah has left him alone. Allah met Him in person which is a rare distinction and assured Him that Allah will never leave Him alone. ☐ Mairaj gave him spiritual strength, meeting with Allah, receiving special gifts, observing Heaven and Hell and above all getting confirmation of his leadership over all Prophets boosted his morale. ☐ The way his companions especially Abu Bakr (RA) responded and believed in Mai'raj without asking for proofs, reflects the trust and belief of His companions which gave Him more strength.

Q (b) How did this journey help the Prophet in his mission? [4]

Points to be covered

- ☐ Quraysh had been persecuting and opposing Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) for a decade and were not ready to accept His message. Isra and Mai'raj gave motivation to continue His mission despite very limited outcome from Quraysh.
- ☐ During interval of Revelation, Quraysh mocked Him that Allah has left Him alone. Isra and Mai'raj comforted Him and He got the reassurance that Allah will never leave Him alone.
- ☐ Observing heaven and hell and other scenarios made his mind clear about the Do's and Don'ts for his Ummah.
- ☐ Leading all Prophets in prayer, Special treatment and meeting Allah, gave him more confidence, boosted His morale and He realized His great status among all other Prophets.



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